about him must be taken while he had not well-mastered the (Aūzbeg) horde or grown very strong’. In the message, he had sent out a verse:[*]

> To-day, while thou canst, quench the fire,
> Once ablaze it will burn up the world;
> Let thy foe not fix string to his bow,
> While an arrow of thine can pierce him;

And having set this premise, Babur proposed to get out of his circumstances laced with humiliation and pain. Babur was already dreaming that once he reached Moghūlistān and Turfān, his reins would be in his control. He was assuming that the phase of anxiety would vanish. Babur did not put anyone in possession of his over-ambitious plan.

The Khwāja laid out Babur’s plan thoroughly before Shāh Begum and the Khān. Initially, they refused to consent. Perhaps they were tied with guilt that Babur was seeking leave for not having received much kindness. But finally, Babur was granted the leave, although delayed.

The Younger Khān Arrives in Tashkent

Babur had planned his visit to China and taken leave by creating a strong, confident image of the younger Khān (Ahmad Alacha) in the minds of the Khān and Shāh Begum. Just then, an emissary informed that the younger Khān was already on his way. Babur knew that his arrival would lead to the cancellation of his journey to China. He could mince the minds of the Shāh Begum and the Khān, but not Babur’s.

The nearing of the younger Khān was then announced by a second emissary. Babur along with others went out to give him an honourable welcome along with Shāh Begum, his younger sisters, Sulṭān-nigār Khānum, Daulat Sulṭān Khānum, Sulṭān Muḥammad Khānika and Khān Mīrzā (Wais).

According to Babur, they went to the tombs of prophets Abraham and Issacs. He mentioned in the *Baburnama* that they were in a village called Yagha somewhere in between Tashkent and Sairām.

The younger Khān arrived. His eyes met Babur’s. Though he didn’t dismount immediately, Babur bowed out of respect. With Khān were Sulṭān